

Project Presentation 2025

A NEW WAY OF WORKING

ESPOO CULTURAL CENTRE

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2030



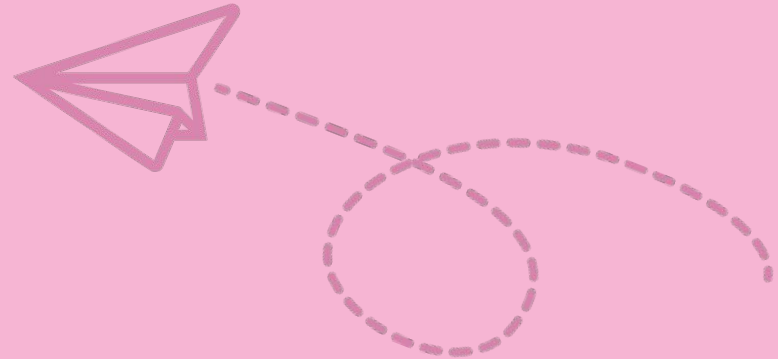
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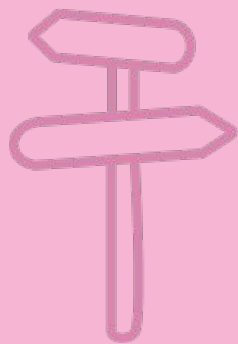
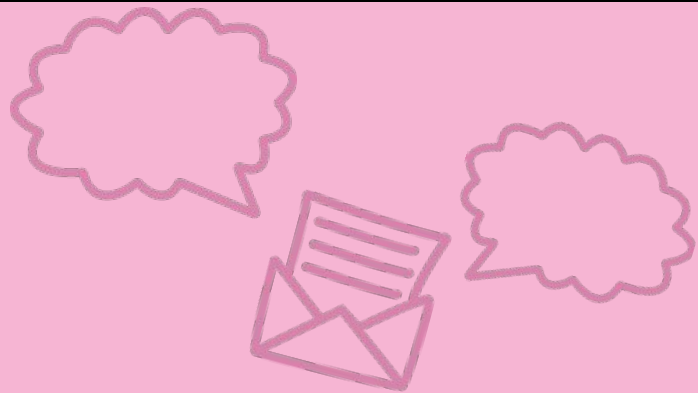
A couple of musicians are having
coffee with a librarian in the
cafeteria, at the heart of Espoo
Cultural Centre. The barista joins in
on the chatter.

The marketing team is buzzing to put together the latest shared campaign while while a music student shows off his new Cello to a sinfonieta member. The janitor theatrically puts away her mop as she wraps up her joke the theatre producer. The Cultural Centre is about to get really busy with visitors!



2030





2030



People come to the cultural centre for the whole experience — a quiet afternoon at the library, followed by music lessons for the kids, and a relaxed date night at one of the performances. As one employee put it “the Cultural centre is like a cluster or stars which has really prestigious organizations within it.” It shines brightly from the outside, while on the inside, the organizations nourish each other.

How do
we build
such a
Future?



HELMET

Tapiolan Kirjasto



Cultural Center
Production

The cultural centre has always been home to remarkable organizations and loyal audiences, full of life but divided by invisible boundaries.



HELMET

Tapiolan Kirjasto



ESPOO
ESBO

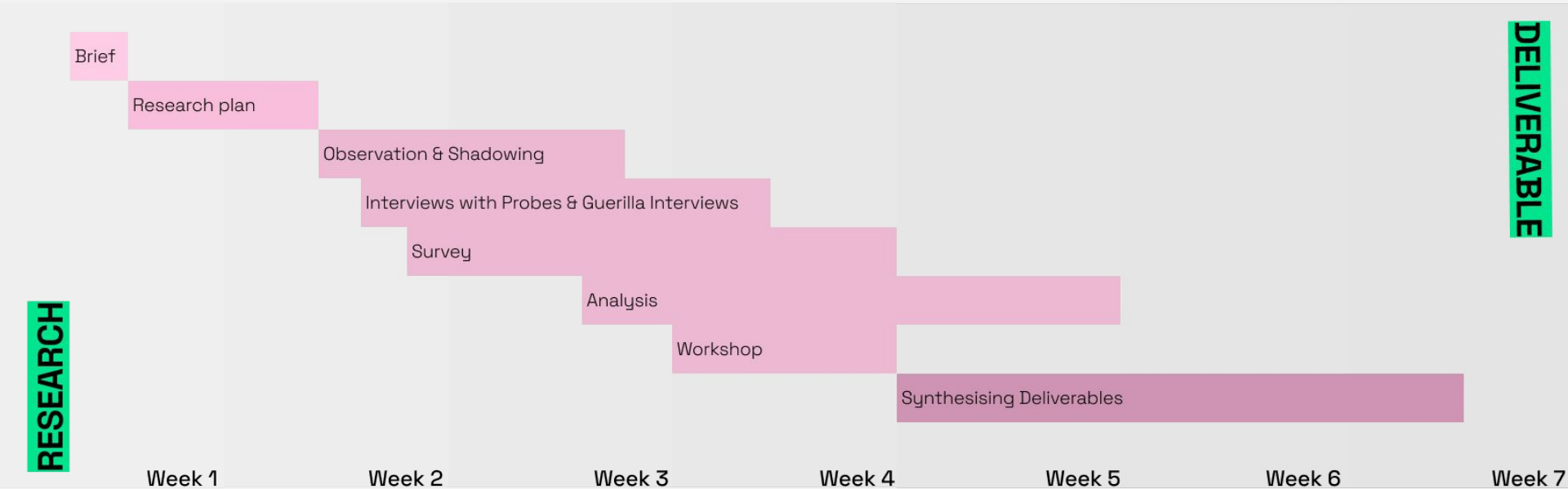
Cultural Center
Production

“We are like isolated islands within one building.”
— manager of an organization

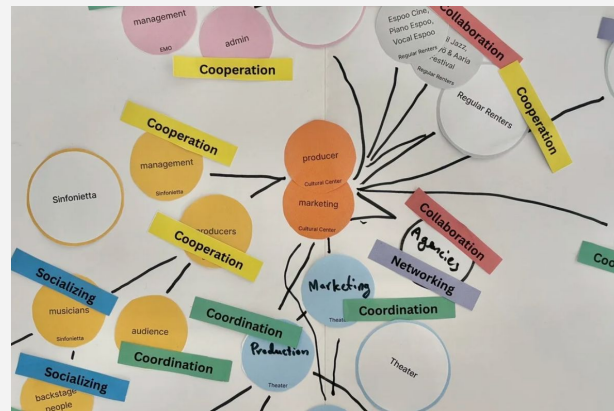
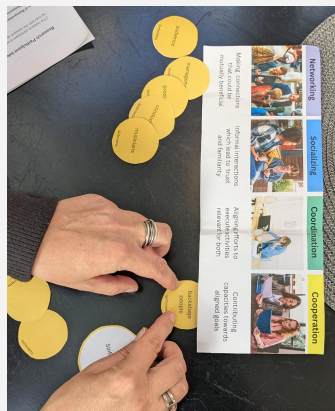
Identify means to strengthen the environment at the Espoo Cultural Centre, shifting the employee culture from mere coexistence to collaboration with a sense of belonging and shared pride in their united identity.

— project brief

Project Process



Research Overview



- 89 Survey Responses
- 7 Interviews with Probes
- 2 Guerilla Interviews
- 3 Shadowing
- 1 Observation
- 1 Workshop

Metaphors for Ecosystem Thinking



“Like a beautiful coral reef with different colors, existing together in harmony, and they can all be their own different things.”



“Without the roots there wouldn't be a tree, so the roots have to be in order.”



“When we have things happening, I want us to be working together, and it's like buzzing with energy.”

What is stopping Kultsa from getting there?

image: partition between organizations

Inter-organizational communication is fragmented.

“Information is maybe not moving as well as it could be.”

— interview staff member at cultural center

Absence of shared spaces reinforces walls.

“Everything should be common, like entry doors so that we can greet each other in the morning.”

“Break rooms are separate and access is restricted”

— manager at the workshop

Unclear ownership prevents collaborative ideas from taking shape.

“We could always meet up and talk, but is it going to be worth anything?”

— interview staff member, theatre

Starting Point for Change

image: vocalizing shared aspirations

Shared aspirations can be the foundation.

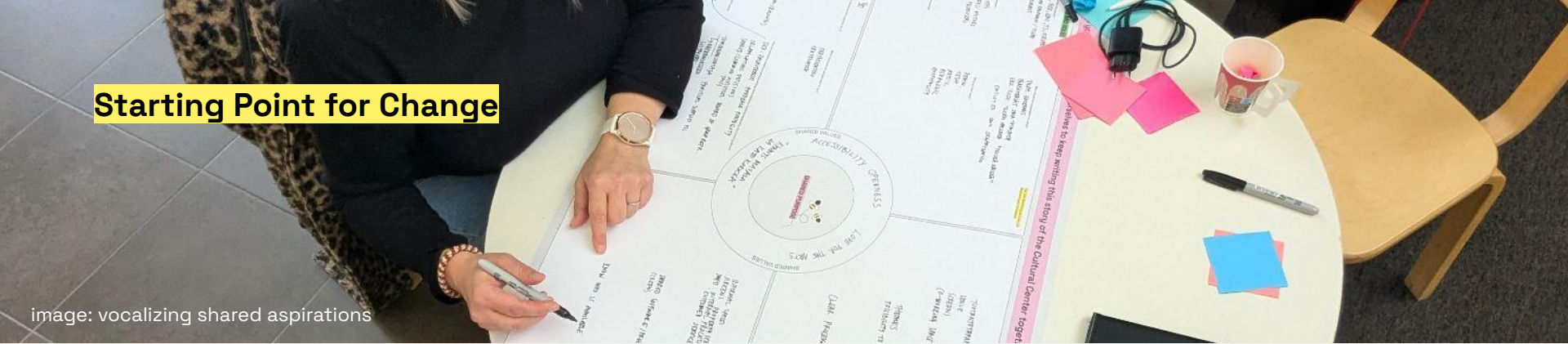
“I was surprised how we all share the same future vision and goals.”

— manager at the workshop

Desire for connection through spaces and events.

72% respondents would like to participate in joint activities of events that involve multiple organizations,

— survey result



Why now

Experiment

building momentum

2026-2027

Transition

navigating change

2027-2030

Rebirth

cultivating growth

2030 →

With a major renovation beginning in 2026, this disruption creates a rare **opportunity to co-create and test a new way of working.**

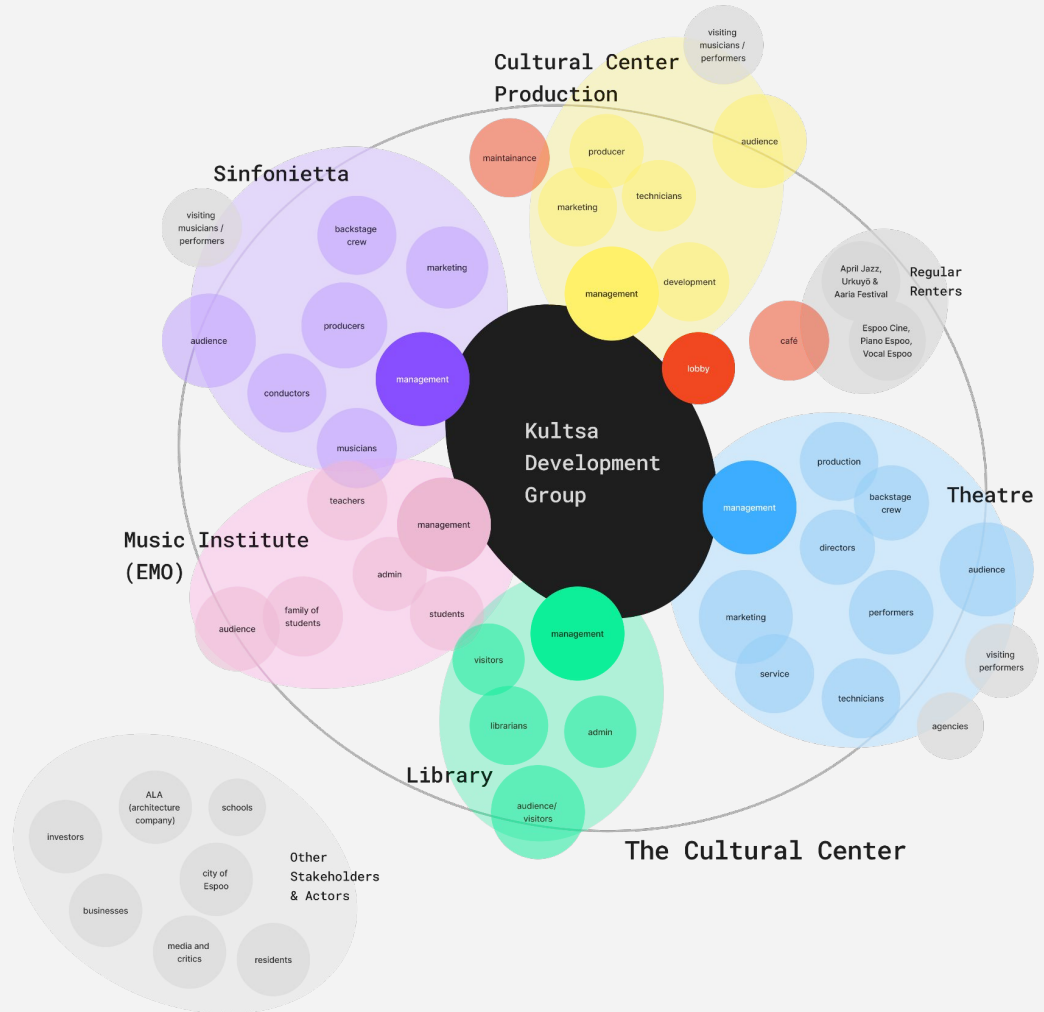
“We need to start with small things
that we can try out immediately.”

— project partner

Proposal

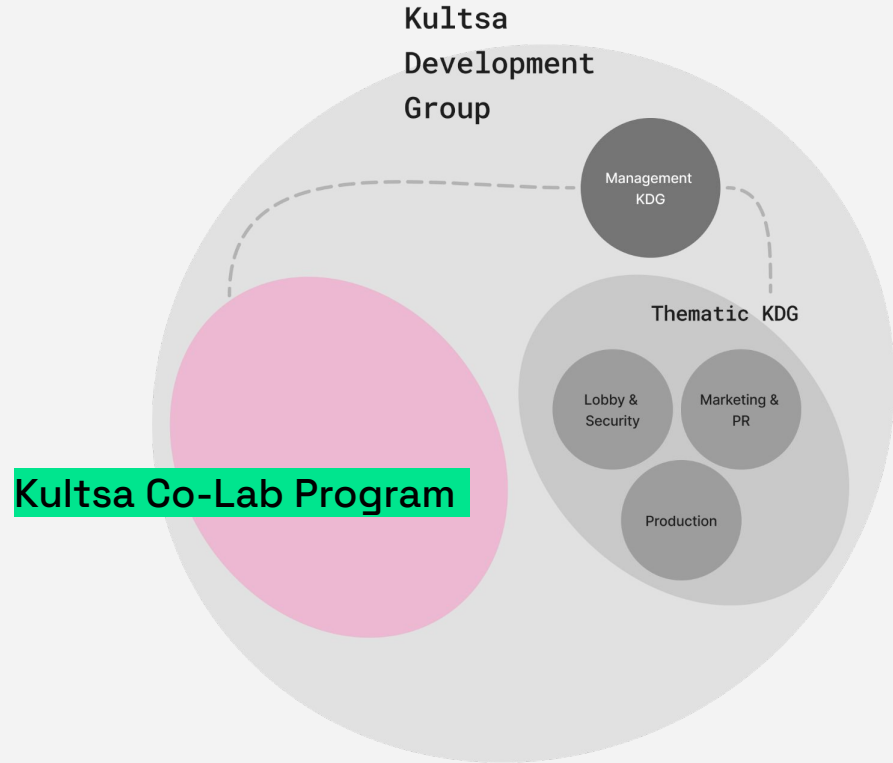
Kultsa Development Group

The **Kultsa Development Group** is uniquely **positioned** to mobilize cultural change by representing, engaging and connecting employees from different roles across organizations.



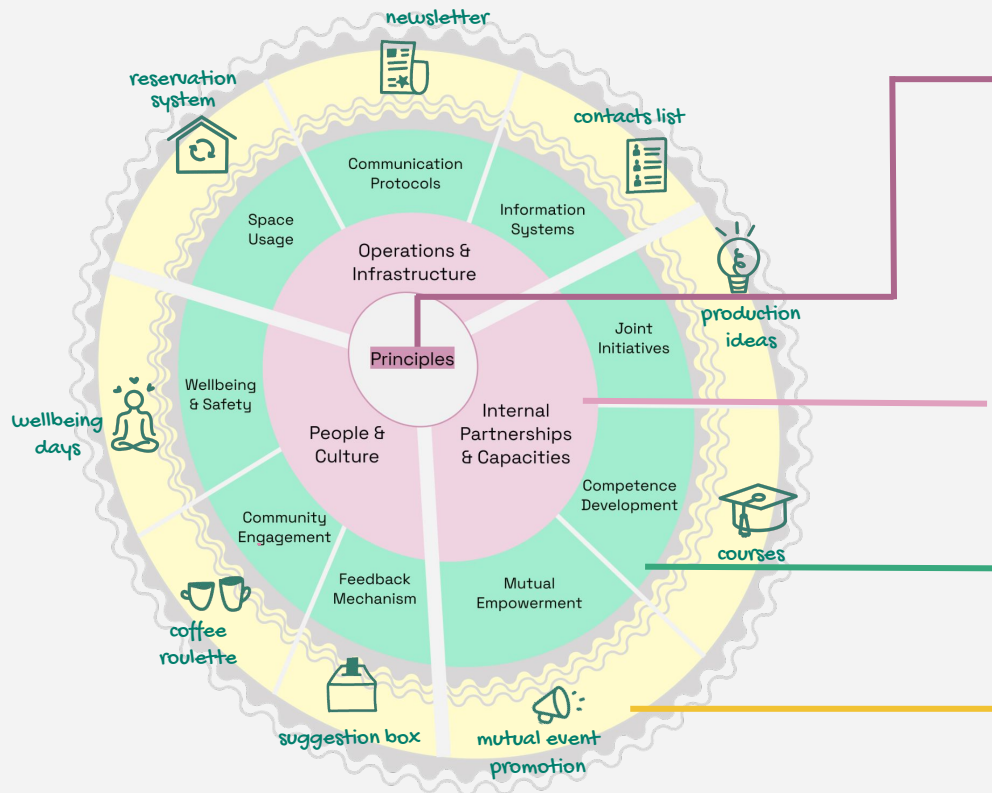
Proposal

The Kultsa Co-Lab Program is a **new, experimental way of working** that is designed to help the Espoo Cultural Centre grow from a workplace into a self-developing community of practice.



Proposal

Kultsa Co-Lab Program



Rooted in Principles

Core principles that guide how change should feel and be practiced across the program.

Organized as Labs

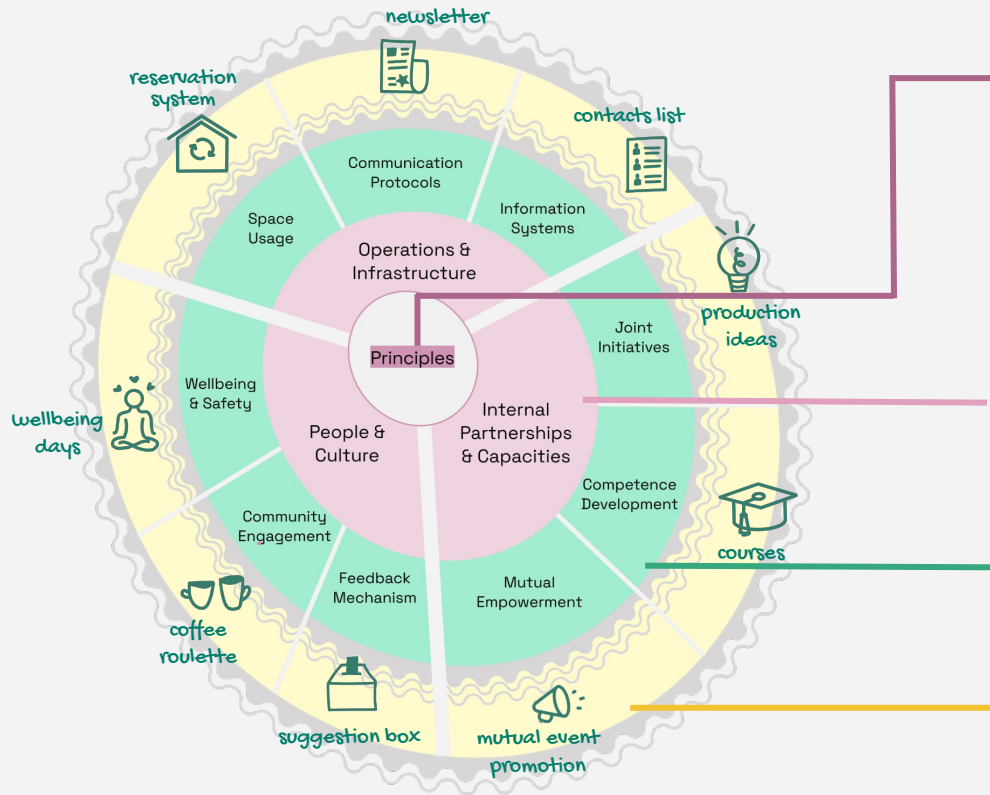
Cross-organizational working groups of people driving collaboration and change within specific focus areas.

Activated through Practices

Structured approaches within each Lab that serve as entry points for new ways of working together.

Realized through Experimentation

Testing concrete actions and ideas within practices to discover what works in practice and refine ways of working.



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Defining the Guiding principles together



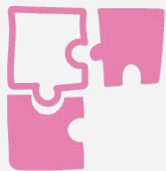
We try out new things and set new standards.



We create a safe space to experiment, express and reflect.



We regularly communicate progress and obstacles to keep our program in motion.



Every member brings equally important and valid perspectives.

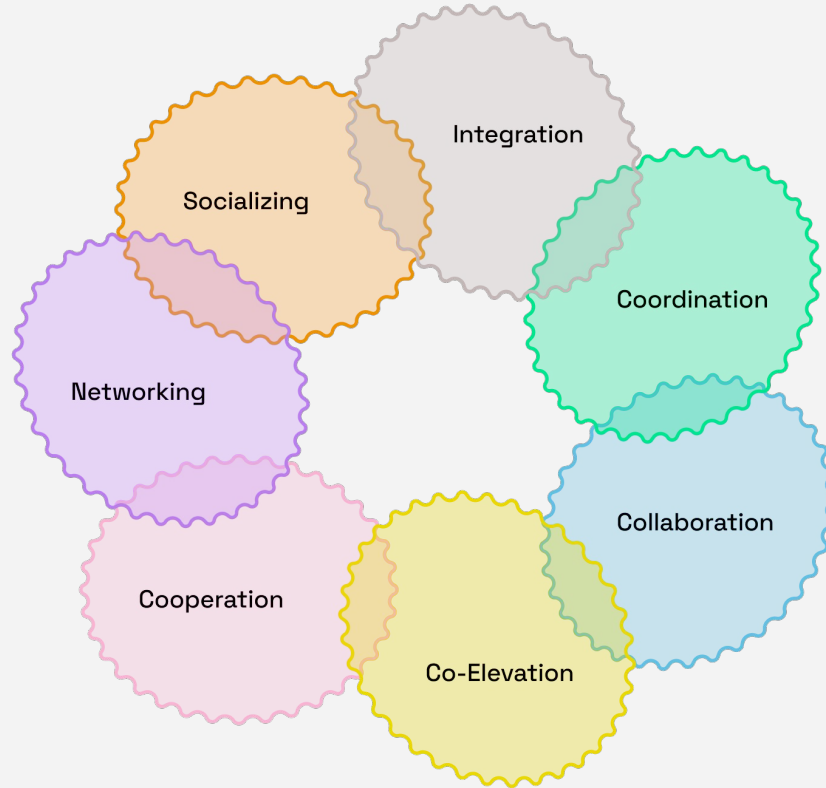


We are excited to try new and creative approaches.



We own our practices individually and as a group.

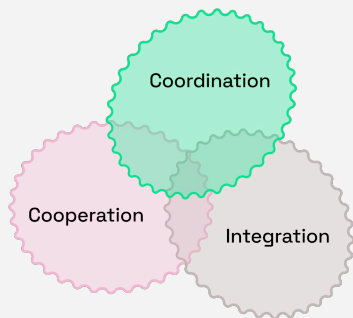
Entangled Modes of Collaboration



Example Lab Overview

Operations & Infrastructure Lab - Overview

Dominant
collaboration modes:



Practices:

Information System

Establishing clear practices for keeping people and activities visible and accessible.

Communication Protocol

Aligning on methods for contacting and responding across organizations.

Space Usage

Defining practices for reserving and utilizing shared, private, formal, and informal spaces effectively.

Experiment Examples:



contacts list



newsletter

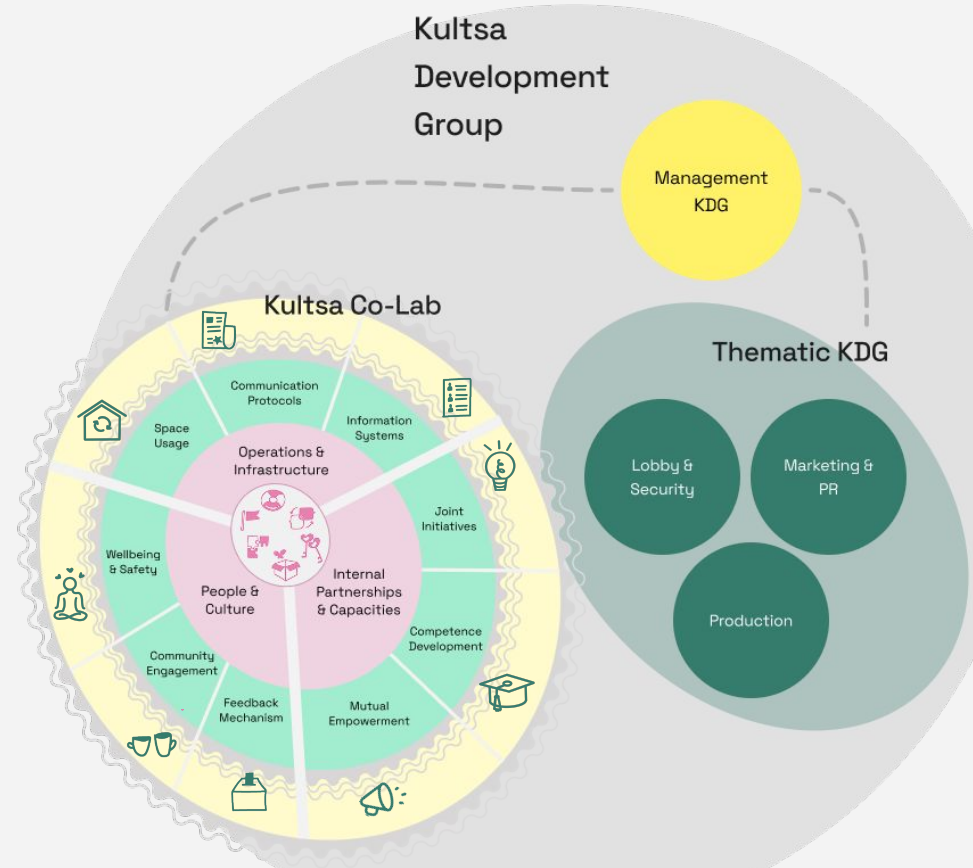


reservation
system

Kultsa Co-Lab Program

Anchored in knowledge sharing and iteration,
resulting in implementation for long-term change

The program does not work in isolation. It connects
back to the Cultural Center as a whole through
transparent communication of results.



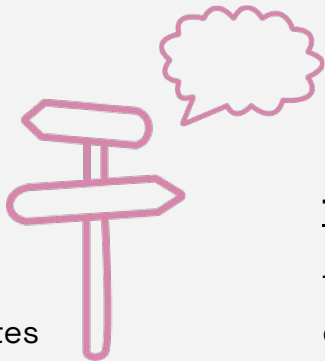
The Co-Lab Mindset



Experiment Example : Kultsa Social Club

Design:

The People & Culture Lab ideates on what the Social Club would look like and its operational details.



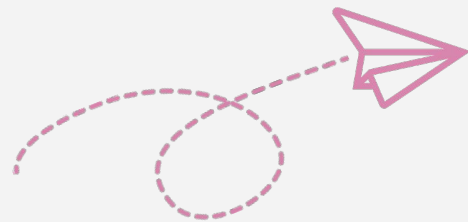
Test:

The Lab puts out communication about the social club to get it started, and makes on-site observations.



Evaluate:

The Lab reflects on their observations, has a cross-lab evaluation, and share final insights with the Kultsa. If the overall results are positive, it is handed over to management for rollout.



Supporting Tools

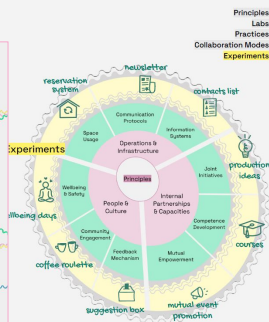
Overview Program

- guided by principles
- organized by people within three labs
- activated by practices and ownership
- strengthen collaboration
- driven by
- anchored iteration, r
- for long-t

Program Structure

Lab experiment with concrete

Concept Handbook Kultsa Co-Lab Program



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Concept Handbook

The Co-Lab Canvas

GROUPS AND ROLES



What are the tasks?

Who should be responsible for what?

WORK STYLES

Meeting Times

How do we ensure accountability?

Decision Making Process

What decision-making process or structure you envisaged?



COMMUNICATION

Communication methods

Conflict Resolution



TOOLS AND RESOURCES

Resources needed (skills, time, space, informal spaces, etc.)?

What kinds of tools, platforms and technologies are needed?

What rituals or routines will be helpful?

Co-Lab Starter Canvas

Anticipated Outcomes



For employees:

A feeling of belonging and greater ownership of the services provided by the Cultural Centre



For organizations:

From existing in the space in the Cultural Centre to being an active contributor to the service ecosystem



For Cultural Centre:

Strengthening its position as a leader as both a pioneering creative institution as well as a great place to work



For Espoo City:

The city attracts residents and visitors with its diverse and welcoming ecosystem for creative and cultural pursuits

Success Metrics

Belonging:

Employees feel connected to the Cultural Centre Community

Indicators:

- Pride in Kultsa
- Cross-organizational engagement
- Engagement in joint events and initiatives
- How employees talk about their shared identity
- Use of common spaces

Clarity:

Employees have clarity about protocols and key contacts

Indicators:

- Increased initiation of cross-organizational collaboration at various levels
- Use of shared communication channels
- Awareness of Kultsa-wide initiatives

Excitement:

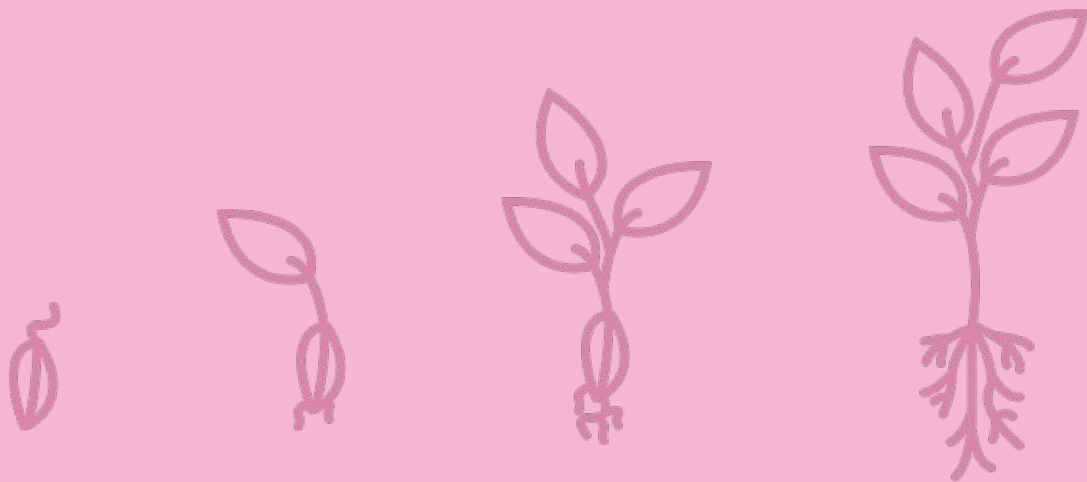
Employees are eager to shape the Cultural Centre ecosystem

Indicators:

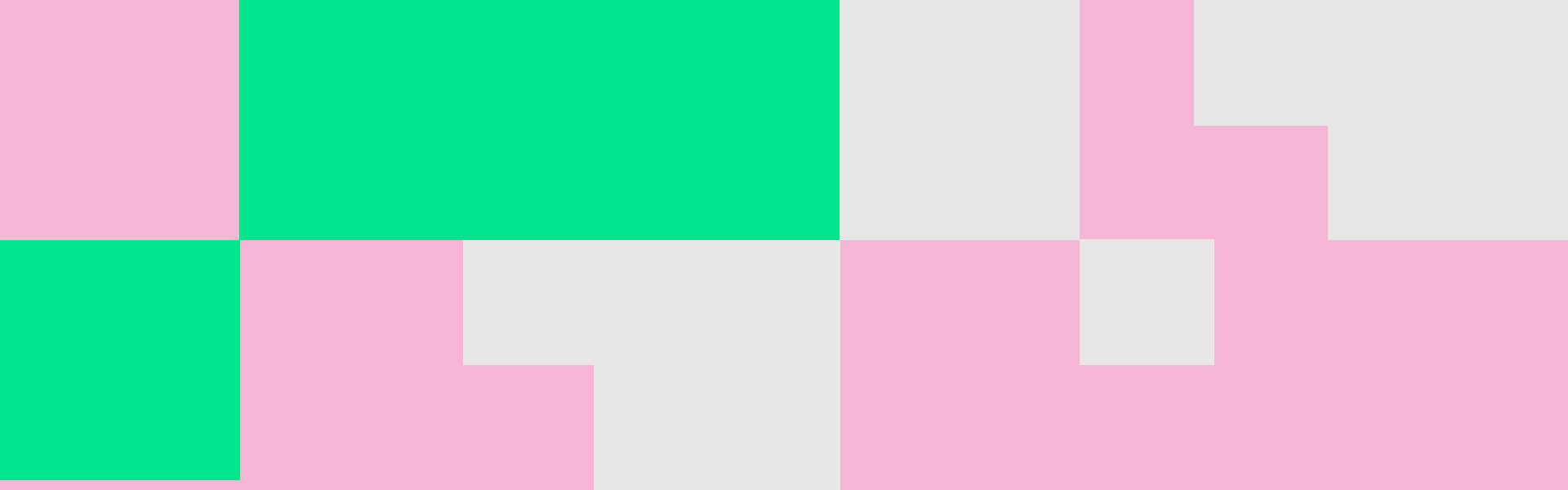
- Number of ideas shared
- Engagement in experiments
- Momentum to turn experiments into long-term change
- Excitement in everyday conversations

The Kultsa Co-Lab Program aims for collaboration, belonging, and shared learning across organizations. It empowers employees to take initiative, communicate openly, and continuously improve how Kultsa works as one community.





The Kultsa Co-Lab Program plants the seeds for long-term cultural change.



KIITOS!